

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Law English



Conversation lab

12 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For lawyers, paralegals, compliance staff, contracts specialists, legal operations teams, and law-adjacent professionals.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 Client Intake: Strong Emotions, Missing Facts
- 02 Partner Assignment: Research Memo Under Pressure
- 03 Contract Redline: Indemnity and Liability Cap
- 04 Discovery Meet-and-Confer: Overbroad Requests
- 05 Deposition Prep: Nervous Witness
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- 07 Motion Strategy: Dismiss or Summary Judgment?
- 08 Settlement Caucus: Risk, Cost, and Authority
- 09 Compliance Review: Advertising Claim Substantiation
- 10 Board Briefing: Material Risk and Disclosure
- 11 Internal Investigation: Neutral Interviewing
- 12 Oral Argument: Answering the Hard Question

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Client Intake: Strong Emotions, Missing Facts

A potential client calls after receiving a demand letter from a former business partner.

Roles: Client / Legal team / Associate counsel

Client: They are lying. Can you tell them we will sue immediately?

Legal team: I understand this feels urgent. Before we discuss strategy, I need to gather facts and run a conflict check.

Associate counsel: Can you send the demand letter, the contract, and any recent emails with the former partner? Also, please list the company names and individuals involved so we can check conflicts.

Client: So do we have a case?

Associate counsel: I cannot assess that responsibly from one call. After we review the documents and confirm scope, we can identify claims, defenses, deadlines, and practical options.

Client: I can send the letter and contract through your secure intake channel. What else do you need before deciding whether to act?

Associate counsel: The party names for the conflict check and the relevant dates. We will explain any engagement terms before undertaking representation.

Notice the professional language

Good intake language protects trust without promising an outcome.

Conflict checks and engagement scope should come before substantive commitments.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Partner Assignment: Research Memo Under Pressure

A partner asks for a quick memo on whether a forum-selection clause is enforceable.

Roles: Partner / Associate counsel

Partner: I need an answer by noon. Is the forum-selection clause enforceable?

Associate counsel: I can give you a short answer by noon. To focus the research, which jurisdiction controls, and are we challenging enforcement or defending it?

Partner: Defending it in federal court. The contract chooses Delaware law but the case was filed in California.

Associate counsel: Understood. I'll assess the governing procedural framework, relevant federal and state authority, the clause wording, and procedural posture. I'll identify binding and persuasive sources and flag contrary authority rather than assume one jurisdiction label settles the question.

Partner: Focus the initial memo on the procedural options and flag what you cannot verify by noon.

Associate counsel: I will distinguish the preliminary answer from any research still in progress and identify the source for each proposition.

Notice the professional language

Clarify jurisdiction, posture, desired use, and deadline before researching.

A legal memo should say how strong the answer is and why.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Contract Redline: Indemnity and Liability Cap

A SaaS vendor and enterprise customer negotiate risk allocation.

Roles: Sales lead / Lawyer / Associate counsel

Sales lead: The customer rejected our limitation of liability. Can we just accept?

Lawyer: Not without understanding the exposure.

Associate counsel: The issue is not only the cap amount. Their redline excludes confidentiality, data security, IP infringement, and indemnity claims from the cap. That could create uncapped exposure.

Sales lead: What is a reasonable fallback?

Associate counsel: We can offer a super-cap for data security and IP claims, tied to a multiple of fees, while keeping consequential damages excluded. I would not accept unlimited liability without executive approval.

Sales lead: I will send the business rationale and the complete redline to the review team.

Associate counsel: Include the customer's stated concern so we can assess appropriate alternatives without accepting unreviewed exposure.

Notice the professional language

Limitation of liability - A clause limiting the amount or type of damages recoverable.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Discovery Meet-and-Confer: Overbroad Requests

Opposing counsel requests all communications from five years across every product line.

Roles: Opposing counsel / Associate counsel

Opposing counsel: Your objections are boilerplate. We need all communications to understand the pattern.

Associate counsel: We disagree that the request is proportional as drafted. It covers unrelated products, custodians, and time periods. We can propose targeted custodians, search terms, and a three-year window tied to the claims.

Opposing counsel: You are withholding relevant evidence.

Associate counsel: We are not refusing discovery. We are asking to tailor the scope to nonprivileged, relevant, and proportional material. If you identify specific gaps, we can discuss them.

Opposing counsel: Send the proposed custodians and date range. We can identify any concrete gaps in that approach.

Associate counsel: I will circulate a written proposal and preserve our positions while we seek a workable, appropriately scoped process.

Notice the professional language

Meet-and-confer language should be firm, record-conscious, and professional.

Avoid personal accusations; keep the discussion on scope, burden, relevance, and proportionality.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Deposition Prep: Nervous Witness

A product manager will be deposed about an internal defect report.

Roles: Witness / Associate counsel

Witness: What if I do not remember? I do not want to look unprepared.

Associate counsel: If you do not remember, say that. Do not guess. Listen to the full question, answer only that question, and ask for clarification if a term is unclear.

Witness: Can I explain the whole background?

Associate counsel: Only if the question asks for it. Your job is to testify truthfully, not to volunteer every fact. If privileged legal advice comes up, pause so counsel can address it.

Witness: If the question assumes something I disagree with, should I still answer yes or no?

Associate counsel: Ask for clarification and answer truthfully. We can practice identifying an unclear premise without inventing or rehearsing facts.

Notice the professional language

Deposition prep language must be ethical: truthful, clear, and non-coaching as to substance.

Learners should avoid scripts that tell a witness what facts to say.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Privilege Review: Copying a Lawyer Is Not Magic

A review team is deciding whether internal emails are privileged.

Roles: Reviewer / Associate counsel

Reviewer: Legal is copied, so this is privileged.

Associate counsel: Maybe, but not automatically. We need to ask whether the email seeks or gives legal advice, who received it, and whether confidentiality was maintained.

Reviewer: This one discusses pricing strategy with counsel copied.

Associate counsel: That may be business advice rather than legal advice. Let's tag it for senior review instead of making the privilege call ourselves.

Reviewer: I will mark the mixed business and legal discussion for the designated reviewer.

Associate counsel: Preserve the context and recipients. The review needs the actual communication, not simply the fact that counsel was copied.

Notice the professional language

Privilege calls are jurisdiction- and fact-sensitive.

Escalation language is better than overconfident privilege conclusions.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Motion Strategy: Dismiss or Summary Judgment?

The team discusses whether to challenge a weak claim early.

Roles: Client / Lawyer / Associate counsel

Client: The claim is false. Can we file a motion to dismiss?

Lawyer: A motion to dismiss usually tests legal sufficiency, not whether the facts are true.

Associate counsel: If the complaint fails to state a required element, dismissal may be worth researching. If our argument depends on evidence outside the pleadings, summary judgment may be the better later vehicle.

Client: So we wait?

Associate counsel: We should evaluate cost, timing, likelihood of success, and whether an early motion educates the court or only delays discovery.

Client: I will ask the litigation team to compare the procedural options and likely costs.

Associate counsel: We will assess those against the actual pleadings, evidence, rules, and your objectives before recommending a filing.

Notice the professional language

Procedural posture changes the available argument.

A client-friendly explanation should distinguish legal sufficiency from factual proof.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Settlement Caucus: Risk, Cost, and Authority

During mediation, the client wants to reject a settlement offer on principle.

Roles: Client / Associate counsel

Client: I would rather go to trial than pay them anything.

Associate counsel: That is a valid business position, but let's separate principle from decision risk. Trial could vindicate the company, but it also means legal fees, management distraction, uncertainty, and potential adverse precedent.

Client: What range do you recommend?

Associate counsel: I recommend reviewing a range based on the evidence, cost, and downside exposure before seeking the client's settlement instructions. Proposed confidentiality, release, and other terms need case-specific legal assessment and explicit authority.

Client: I want to understand that range before giving any settlement authority.

Associate counsel: We will review the assumptions and terms together and record your instructions explicitly.

Notice the professional language

Settlement language should respect client values while surfacing decision consequences.

Authority, release, confidentiality, and non-admission terms often matter as much as amount.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 09 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Compliance Review: Advertising Claim Substantiation

Marketing wants to launch an ad saying a product is 'clinically proven' to improve focus.

Roles: Marketing / Associate counsel

Marketing: Competitors make stronger claims than this. Can we approve it?

Associate counsel: We need substantiation for the express and implied claims before launch. 'Clinically proven' suggests reliable evidence, not just user testimonials.

Marketing: We have a small internal survey.

Associate counsel: That may support customer satisfaction, but probably not a clinical efficacy claim. A safer path is to revise the claim to match the evidence or obtain stronger support before release.

Marketing: I will provide the survey methods and draft wording for review.

Associate counsel: We will assess what those materials support and identify any revision or further substantiation needed before publication.

Notice the professional language

Compliance review often turns on what a reasonable consumer may take from the claim.

The legal team should propose a compliant alternative, not only block the campaign.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 10 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Board Briefing: Material Risk and Disclosure

An in-house legal team briefs executives on a regulatory inquiry.

Roles: CFO / General counsel / Associate counsel

CFO: Do we have to disclose this inquiry?

General counsel: We need a materiality analysis before answering.

Associate counsel: Current facts: the regulator requested documents, no allegations have been filed, potential exposure is uncertain, and the issue relates to a growing product line. The disclosure question depends on likelihood, magnitude, existing public statements, and investor significance.

CFO: Can we say it is not material?

Associate counsel: I would not say that yet. We can say legal is assessing materiality and will update the disclosure committee after reviewing the request and business impact.

CFO: I will provide the relevant business figures and current public statements.

Associate counsel: That context will help the disclosure team assess the issue without prejudging materiality.

Notice the professional language

Materiality language should not be rushed.

Board and executive updates need known facts, unknowns, timing, owner, and decision path.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 11 / 8 SPEAKING TURNS

Internal Investigation: Neutral Interviewing

Legal interviews an employee about a possible policy violation.

Roles: Employee / Associate counsel

Employee: Am I being accused of something?

Associate counsel: We are gathering facts about a concern that was reported. I am not here to argue with you or make a final decision today.

Employee: Should I delete my personal notes?

Associate counsel: No. Please preserve documents and messages that may relate to this topic. If you are unsure whether something is relevant, ask before deleting or changing it.

Employee: Can you tell me what other people said?

Associate counsel: I cannot share interview details. I can ask you about your own recollection and any documents that may help us understand the timeline.

Employee: I can describe what I remember and identify the records that may help.

Associate counsel: Please distinguish what you observed directly from what you heard later. We will follow the approved process for further questions.

Notice the professional language

Investigation questions should avoid suggesting the desired answer.

Preservation language should be simple, direct, and documented.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 12 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Oral Argument: Answering the Hard Question

Moot-court exercise about an invented contract. For this exercise, subsection (b) covers notice before termination; subsection (c) addresses post-termination conduct and its remedy. The advocates are testing a hypothetical reading, not describing an actual statute.

Roles: Judge / Associate counsel

Judge: Counsel, does your reading make subsection (c) unnecessary?

Associate counsel: No, Your Honor. Subsection (c) still does work in two situations. First, it covers post-termination conduct. Second, it supplies the remedy when the notice period has expired.

Judge: But the other side says that is not in the text.

Associate counsel: Respectfully, the text supports it when subsections (b) and (c) are read together. If the Court disagrees, our narrower fallback is that dismissal should be without prejudice because the defect is curable.

Judge: Counsel, explain how your fallback preserves the issue for a revised pleading in this exercise.

Associate counsel: Our proposed fallback allows an amendment addressing the identified defect; it does not ask the Court to treat the current pleading as sufficient.

Notice the professional language

Advocacy language should answer directly, then explain.

Fallback arguments preserve credibility when the main argument faces pressure.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Legal English Mindset: Facts, Issues, Rules, Risk

SHARED CASE

An internal case note says a supplier "breached the contract." The team has the delivery email but has not reviewed the signed agreement.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The delivery email records a delay. Whether that amounts to a breach requires review of the agreement and relevant law. I'll separate the documented facts from the legal questions in the note.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Client Intake, Scope, Conflicts, and Confidentiality

SHARED CASE

A prospective client sends a long description of a dispute and asks for immediate advice. The intake team has not completed its conflict check.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Before we discuss advice, could you provide the names of the parties and the type of assistance you are seeking? Our team needs to complete intake and confirm the scope of any engagement.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Litigation Lifecycle: Pleadings, Motions, Deadlines, Strategy

SHARED CASE

A litigation task list has two dates from different documents. The supervising lawyer has not confirmed which deadline controls.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

The task list contains conflicting dates. I have attached both source documents and flagged the issue for your review. Please confirm the controlling deadline before I update the calendar.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Discovery, ESI, Privilege Review, and Depositions

SHARED CASE

A document reviewer finds an email chain that may contain privileged communications. It is in a review set, not yet a production set.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ...

Cover this until after your first attempt

Please review this email chain for potential privilege before a production decision. I've identified the participants and relevant messages. I have not made a final privilege determination.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Legal Research, Authority, and Memo Writing

SHARED CASE

A draft memo cites one decision as controlling authority. The case came from another jurisdiction and the research is still preliminary.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

This decision may help the analysis, but we should not label it binding without checking its authority in the relevant jurisdiction. I'll explain that distinction and identify what further research is needed.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Contracts, Redlines, and Negotiation

SHARED CASE

A draft services agreement requires delivery within ten days. The commercial team needs fifteen days and wants the contract team to propose wording.

Role A | Responding professional

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Useful expressions

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Cover this until after your first attempt

Our delivery team can commit to fifteen days under the current scope. Could we revise the proposed period accordingly? I'll send the business rationale for legal review with the redline.

Second round

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Corporate, Compliance, Regulatory, and Investigation Language

SHARED CASE

An employee interview contains a report of possible misconduct. A manager asks to describe the allegation as a confirmed violation in a summary.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

At this stage, we have an allegation and an interview record. The finding is not established. I'll use neutral wording and identify the questions that the investigation still needs to resolve.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Advocacy, Settlement, Ethics, and Professional Judgment

SHARED CASE

Two team members disagree about settlement priorities. One prioritizes timing; the other prioritizes confidentiality. Counsel is preparing for a client discussion.

Role A | Responding professional

Include relevant voices and clarify the decision process. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You hold a relevant concern that has not been discussed. Raise it when invited and ask who will decide. Help the facilitator state one unresolved question accurately.

Useful expressions

Let's hear ... before we decide.

The point we still need to resolve is

Who will make this decision, and what do they need?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Let's separate the objectives before discussing terms. How important are timing and confidentiality to the client? We can present the options and their implications for the client's instructions.

Second round

A participant interrupts or the meeting is running out of time. Protect a turn to speak and close with an accurate decision record.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An email is not the signed agreement

The lesson's internal team has a delivery email but has not reviewed the signed supplier agreement. This is language practice, not legal advice.

01 • Case analyst: The note says the supplier breached the contract, but we have only reviewed the delivery email.

02 • Supervising lawyer: Then that conclusion goes beyond the material currently examined. What can we state accurately?

03 • Case analyst: We can describe what the email says and identify the contract review as pending.

04 • Supervising lawyer: Good. Does the email itself establish the governing jurisdiction or the relevant contractual obligation?

05 • Case analyst: We haven't established either. I shouldn't supply those facts from an assumption.

06 • Supervising lawyer: Nor should we assume materiality before reviewing the obligation and surrounding facts.

07 • Case analyst: Would it be clearer to attribute the allegation rather than assert breach ourselves?

08 • Supervising lawyer: Yes, provided the record identifies who actually made that allegation.

09 • Case analyst: I'll distinguish the recorded communication, any attributed allegation, and the unanswered legal questions.

10 • Supervising lawyer: Then request the signed agreement for review and leave the conclusion open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A witness reports a conversation

Separate fictional training case: a witness reports that a manager promised a refund; no recording or written confirmation is available.

01 • Junior lawyer: The witness says a manager promised a refund. Can we state that the promise occurred?

02 • Senior lawyer: We can state what the witness reported, while keeping corroboration separate.

03 • Junior lawyer: The interview note is detailed, but we have no recording or written confirmation.

04 • Senior lawyer: Detail may help assessment; it doesn't convert a reported account into independently verified fact.

05 • Junior lawyer: Should I say the witness alleges a promise, without asserting its legal effect?

06 • Senior lawyer: Attribute the account clearly. Avoid suggesting a conclusion about enforceability from this information alone.

07 • Junior lawyer: We also haven't identified which jurisdiction's rules would need consideration.

08 • Senior lawyer: Then list that as an open research question, not a fact you can infer.

09 • Junior lawyer: I'll preserve the account and ask what supporting material can appropriately be obtained.

10 • Senior lawyer: Good. Our summary should let the reader distinguish evidence, allegations, and analysis.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A missing attachment and a materiality claim

Separate fictional training case: an internal file lacks a contract attachment, but no one has established whether the signed original included it.

01 • Paralegal: Our file lacks the attachment. The draft summary calls that a material defect in the agreement.

02 • Supervising lawyer: That conflates our incomplete file with the agreement's contents. Have we reviewed the original?

03 • Paralegal: No. We know only that this internal copy doesn't contain the attachment.

04 • Supervising lawyer: Then describe that limitation before making any assertion about the agreement itself.

05 • Paralegal: Would materiality mean whether the missing information matters to the issue being considered?

06 • Supervising lawyer: Broadly, yes, but the relevant assessment depends on facts and the applicable legal context.

07 • Paralegal: So I shouldn't label the omission material merely because the attachment sounds important.

08 • Supervising lawyer: Correct. Request the complete executed version and preserve the source of this copy.

09 • Paralegal: I'll change the summary to an incomplete-file observation, with legal significance unresolved.

10 • Supervising lawyer: That gives us a reliable starting point without disguising uncertainty as a finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Legal English Mindset: Facts, Issues, Rules, Risk

An internal case note says a supplier "breached the contract." The team has the delivery email but has not reviewed the signed agreement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The delivery email records a delay. Whether that amounts to a breach requires review of the agreement and relevant law. I'll separate the documented facts from the legal questions in the note.

Scenario 2 | A draft labeled final

A fictional case folder contains a document named Final Agreement, but its signature fields are blank. No executed version has been located. A colleague wants to call its terms binding.

Role A: You are the case assistant. Explain what the file shows without drawing a legal conclusion.

Role B: You supervise the review. Ask what version evidence is missing and identify the next review step.

Possible opening: The filename says final, but this copy has blank signature fields and no executed version is available.

Success checks

- Separate the filename from execution evidence.
- Avoid deciding enforceability from the supplied facts.
- Agree to seek version evidence and qualified review.

Add a complication: The colleague argues that the filename alone proves acceptance.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Clarifying intake before substantive advice

The lesson's prospective client has sent a dispute account; the conflict check is incomplete. No representation is assumed.

01 • Intake coordinator: We've received the dispute description, but the conflict check hasn't been completed.

02 • Prospective client: Can the lawyer tell me what to do immediately while that check is underway?

03 • Intake coordinator: I can't promise substantive advice or representation before the intake review establishes the next step.

04 • Prospective client: What clarification do you need from me now, without another long account?

05 • Intake coordinator: Please confirm the parties' names through the intake channel so the conflict review can proceed.

06 • Prospective client: Does sending information mean we already have an engagement letter or agreed scope?

07 • Intake coordinator: No engagement or scope of representation has been confirmed in this exchange.

08 • Prospective client: I also want to know how the information I've sent will be handled.

09 • Intake coordinator: I'll refer that confidentiality question to the responsible intake professional rather than promise an unsupported rule.

10 • Prospective client: Please confirm the intake status and who will explain the next steps.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Which company is seeking representation?

Separate fictional intake: a director contacts a firm about a dispute involving two related companies; the intended client is unclear.

01 • Intake lawyer: When you say our company, which legal entity is seeking assistance with the dispute?

02 • Company director: There are two related companies involved, and I haven't specified which one would engage you.

03 • Intake lawyer: That distinction matters for the conflict check and any proposed scope of representation.

04 • Company director: Can't you use the group's trading name and sort the entity out later?

05 • Intake lawyer: We should clarify the prospective client before assuming whom the firm would represent.

06 • Company director: I'll confirm the entity names. Does that mean both companies will become clients?

07 • Intake lawyer: No. Supplying names for intake doesn't itself establish an engagement with either company.

08 • Company director: What should I clarify internally before the next conversation with your team?

09 • Intake lawyer: Identify who seeks representation and who can discuss the proposed engagement on its behalf.

10 • Company director: I'll bring that information without describing the firm as already acting for us.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A new issue outside the stated assignment

Separate fictional training case: an existing engagement covers reviewing a lease draft; a client now asks about an unrelated employment dispute.

01 • Client representative: While you review our lease draft, could you advise on an employment dispute too?

02 • Relationship lawyer: Could you clarify whether you are requesting a separate engagement for that matter?

03 • Client representative: I assumed the existing engagement letter covered any legal question from our business.

04 • Relationship lawyer: The stated assignment covers the lease review. We shouldn't assume an unrelated dispute is included.

05 • Client representative: Would the new issue require another conflict-of-interest check before anyone considers advice?

06 • Relationship lawyer: The intake team needs to assess the new matter and determine the appropriate review.

07 • Client representative: Then I should provide limited identifying information through the designated channel first?

08 • Relationship lawyer: Yes. We'll clarify the proposed scope and information handling before treating the new work as accepted.

09 • Client representative: I'll keep the two matters separate when I speak with our team.

10 • Relationship lawyer: Thank you. The lease assignment remains distinct from the employment inquiry under review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Client Intake, Scope, Conflicts, and Confidentiality

A prospective client sends a long description of a dispute and asks for immediate advice. The intake team has not completed its conflict check.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Before we discuss advice, could you provide the names of the parties and the type of assistance you are seeking? Our team needs to complete intake and confirm the scope of any engagement.

Scenario 2 | A referral without a confirmed client

A fictional consultant introduces a business owner to a firm and asks to join the intake call. The owner has not said whether they want the consultant present, and no engagement is established.

Role A: You coordinate intake. Clarify the owner's preference and the consultant's proposed role before discussing substance.

Role B: You are the business owner. State that the consultant made the introduction but their continuing involvement is undecided.

Possible opening: Before discussing the matter, could we clarify who you want present and in what role?

Success checks

- Separate referral from authorization to participate.
- Keep representation and information-sharing arrangements unconfirmed.
- Agree who will clarify participation before substantive discussion.

Add a complication: The consultant assumes making the referral gives them access to all subsequent discussions.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two dates awaiting supervisory review

The lesson's litigation list contains dates from two documents; the supervising lawyer has not confirmed the controlling deadline.

01 • Litigation assistant: I've identified two different dates in the source documents, but neither is confirmed as controlling.

02 • Supervising lawyer: What work have you completed so far on the task list?

03 • Litigation assistant: I've retained both dates with their sources and flagged the conflict for your review.

04 • Supervising lawyer: Good. Don't choose one merely because it appears in the newer-looking document.

05 • Litigation assistant: Should I describe the deadline as confirmed if a date appears in an order?

06 • Supervising lawyer: Not without reviewing the relevant materials and their effect in this matter.

07 • Litigation assistant: Then the source collection is complete, while the deadline determination remains pending.

08 • Supervising lawyer: Correct. Keep the potential scheduling impact visible and route the issue for prompt review.

09 • Litigation assistant: I'll avoid updating dependent tasks as though one date had already been approved.

10 • Supervising lawyer: Bring both documents to me so the next scheduling instruction can be based on review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Drafted is not filed

Separate fictional litigation exercise: an answer has been drafted and awaits lawyer approval; there is no filing confirmation.

01 • Case manager: The dashboard says answer complete. Does that mean it has been filed?

02 • Litigation paralegal: No. The draft is complete, but lawyer approval and filing confirmation are still pending.

03 • Case manager: We should distinguish those stages so the client doesn't assume a procedural step occurred.

04 • Litigation paralegal: Agreed. I'll change the status to draft ready for review, not filed.

05 • Case manager: Have you checked any deadline against the supervising lawyer's instructions for this matter?

06 • Litigation paralegal: That's outside the status shown here. I need to confirm it rather than infer compliance.

07 • Case manager: Please flag that dependency and avoid calling the matter fully on schedule.

08 • Litigation paralegal: I'll bring the draft status and scheduling question to the supervising lawyer together.

09 • Case manager: When filing does occur, what will support the next status update?

10 • Litigation paralegal: The appropriate filing confirmation, reviewed through our case process, rather than the draft's existence.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A motion discussed but not authorized

Separate fictional litigation exercise: a team discussed a possible motion, but counsel has not decided whether to pursue it.

01 • Litigation coordinator: The meeting discussed a motion, so I marked motion preparation underway on the tracker.

02 • Associate lawyer: Counsel hasn't decided whether to pursue it. The discussion didn't authorize preparation.

03 • Litigation coordinator: Then my update overstated progress. What status accurately reflects the completed work?

04 • Associate lawyer: The option has been discussed, and the decision on next steps is pending.

05 • Litigation coordinator: Should I assign research or drafting tasks to make progress while we wait?

06 • Associate lawyer: Ask counsel what work is authorized rather than creating tasks from an assumed strategy.

07 • Litigation coordinator: I'll keep that question visible and remove the unsupported underway label.

08 • Associate lawyer: Please retain the discussion note so the unresolved option isn't lost from view.

09 • Litigation coordinator: Understood. The tracker will distinguish an option considered from an approved workstream.

10 • Associate lawyer: That will help counsel give a clear instruction without inheriting a misleading progress claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Litigation Lifecycle: Pleadings, Motions, Deadlines, Strategy

A litigation task list has two dates from different documents. The supervising lawyer has not confirmed which deadline controls.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The task list contains conflicting dates. I have attached both source documents and flagged the issue for your review. Please confirm the controlling deadline before I update the calendar.

Scenario 2 | A hearing request without a confirmed listing

A fictional case record shows that a hearing request was submitted, but no confirmed listing is present. A client asks whether attendance should be arranged for the requested date.

Role A: You are the litigation coordinator. Report the submitted request and pending confirmation separately.

Role B: You are the supervising lawyer. Ask what evidence is available and direct the appropriate status check.

Possible opening: The hearing request was submitted, but the record does not yet confirm a listing.

Success checks

- Distinguish a request from a confirmed listing.
- Avoid inventing an attendance instruction or controlling date.
- Agree a status check with the responsible professional.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to treat the requested date as the confirmed hearing date.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Requesting review of a potentially privileged chain

The lesson's email chain is in a review set, not a production set, and privilege is unconfirmed.

01 • Document reviewer: Could you review this email chain for potential privilege before any production decision?

02 • Review lawyer: Where is it currently located, and has it been included in a production set?

03 • Document reviewer: It is in the review set only. I haven't determined whether privilege applies.

04 • Review lawyer: Good. Keep that distinction explicit instead of describing it as a disclosure incident.

05 • Document reviewer: I'll provide the review reference and explain which passages prompted the concern.

06 • Review lawyer: Use the restricted review system rather than copying the chain into general messages.

07 • Document reviewer: Should I label it privileged or work product now to resolve the queue?

08 • Review lawyer: Flag it for assessment; those determinations require review in the relevant context.

09 • Document reviewer: Please confirm when you can assess it before the production decision is taken.

10 • Review lawyer: I'll confirm the review slot and record the determination through the discovery workflow.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Requesting a missing attachment for discovery review

Separate fictional discovery exercise: a review email refers to an attachment absent from the collected set; its contents are unknown.

01 • Discovery lawyer: Could you check the collection record for the attachment referenced in this email?

02 • ESI coordinator: Yes. Do you want a collection-status check, or are you assuming it was intentionally withheld?

03 • Discovery lawyer: Only a status check. We don't know why the attachment is absent.

04 • ESI coordinator: I'll trace the item reference without describing the missing contents as established evidence.

05 • Discovery lawyer: Please confirm what can be located before we finish assessing the email's context.

06 • ESI coordinator: If I find a matching file, should it move straight into production?

07 • Discovery lawyer: No. It would need the appropriate review, including any privilege concerns, before that decision.

08 • ESI coordinator: Understood. Locating electronically stored information doesn't itself authorize producing it.

09 • Discovery lawyer: Exactly. Return the collection findings and any unresolved link between the email and attachment.

10 • ESI coordinator: I'll report those limits and request further instructions if the reference cannot be resolved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Preparing deposition materials without assuming disclosure

Separate fictional litigation exercise: counsel requests a proposed deposition bundle; some selected documents have unresolved review flags.

01 • Associate lawyer: Could you assemble a proposed deposition bundle and identify documents with unresolved review flags?

02 • Litigation paralegal: Several selections still need review. Should I remove the flags to make the bundle easier to read?

03 • Associate lawyer: No. Counsel needs those flags visible before deciding which materials may be used.

04 • Litigation paralegal: I'll separate cleared selections from items awaiting privilege or work-product assessment.

05 • Associate lawyer: Please don't call the second group privileged as a final determination; assessment is pending.

06 • Litigation paralegal: Understood. What timing should I propose for the review conversation?

07 • Associate lawyer: Ask counsel for a slot before the bundle is finalized, without inventing a deadline.

08 • Litigation paralegal: I'll provide the item references and the specific questions needing a decision.

09 • Associate lawyer: Good. The request is for a reviewable proposal, not authorization to disclose every selection.

10 • Litigation paralegal: I'll confirm that scope when I hand over the bundle for discussion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Discovery, ESI, Privilege Review, and Depositions

A document reviewer finds an email chain that may contain privileged communications. It is in a review set, not yet a production set.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Please review this email chain for potential privilege before a production decision. I've identified the participants and relevant messages. I have not made a final privilege determination.

Scenario 2 | A transcript passage needs a source check

A fictional deposition summary contains a quotation attributed to page twelve, but the available transcript excerpt ends at page ten. No one has checked the complete transcript.

Role A: You are the reviewing lawyer. Request the complete source or a verified passage before relying on the quotation.

Role B: You are the case assistant. Explain the excerpt's limit and arrange the source check without inventing the missing words.

Possible opening: Could you locate the complete transcript so we can verify the quotation attributed to page twelve?

Success checks

- State the page-ten limit accurately.
- Do not treat plausibility as verification.
- Agree a source check before reliance on the quotation.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests retaining the quotation because it sounds consistent with earlier testimony.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Persuasive does not mean controlling

The lesson's preliminary memo cites a decision from another jurisdiction as controlling; its authority has not been established.

01 • Research assistant: The draft calls this decision controlling, although it came from another jurisdiction.

02 • Research lawyer: Then we need to assess its authority rather than assume it binds the relevant court.

03 • Research assistant: Could you explain binding authority and persuasive authority in plain English?

04 • Research lawyer: Binding authority must be followed when applicable; persuasive authority may inform reasoning without controlling it.

05 • Research assistant: So a useful decision isn't automatically a precedent that controls our issue?

06 • Research lawyer: Correct. Jurisdiction, court hierarchy, and the issue need examination before we characterize its role.

07 • Research assistant: The research is still preliminary. I'll preserve that limitation in the discussion.

08 • Research lawyer: Also consider whether relevant facts or reasoning let us distinguish the case.

09 • Research assistant: I'll describe its possible relevance without presenting the memo's legal conclusion as settled.

10 • Research lawyer: Good. Bring the authority question back for review with the supporting research.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A similar outcome with different facts

Separate fictional research exercise: a located decision reaches a favorable outcome, but its facts differ from the client's account.

01 • Junior lawyer: This decision has the outcome we hope for, so I want to lead with it.

02 • Research supervisor: First explain the factual difference. A favorable result alone doesn't establish a close precedent.

03 • Junior lawyer: Would distinguishing the case mean showing why that difference affects its relevance?

04 • Research supervisor: Yes. Explain the meaningful difference rather than merely listing details that don't matter.

05 • Junior lawyer: We haven't assessed whether the difference is legally significant in this matter.

06 • Research supervisor: Then say so. Don't treat a possible distinction as either decisive or irrelevant yet.

07 • Junior lawyer: Should the memo separately discuss the decision's authority and its factual fit?

08 • Research supervisor: Exactly. Those are related questions, but a strong answer to one doesn't resolve the other.

09 • Junior lawyer: I'll bring both questions to review and avoid describing the outcome as guaranteed.

10 • Research supervisor: That will make the research useful without turning analogy into a promise.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A headnote is not the court's full reasoning

Separate fictional research exercise: an assistant has read a case summary but not the full judgment or its subsequent treatment.

01 • Research assistant: The summary states the principle clearly. Can I cite that as the court's complete reasoning?

02 • Research lawyer: Not yet. A summary helps locate an issue, but it doesn't replace reviewing the decision.

03 • Research assistant: So the summary is a research aid, while the judgment supplies the reasoning to examine?

04 • Research lawyer: Correct. We also haven't checked the decision's subsequent treatment or its authority here.

05 • Research assistant: Would calling it binding authority now combine several questions we haven't answered?

06 • Research lawyer: Yes. We need to assess the source, relevant proposition, and applicable authority separately.

07 • Research assistant: I'll locate the judgment and keep the current note labeled preliminary research.

08 • Research lawyer: Please identify the actual passage supporting the proposition rather than copying the summary alone.

09 • Research assistant: Then I'll ask for review of its relevance and any limits before relying on it.

10 • Research lawyer: Good. Clear source distinctions are more useful than an unsupported authoritative label.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Legal Research, Authority, and Memo Writing

A draft memo cites one decision as controlling authority. The case came from another jurisdiction and the research is still preliminary.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: This decision may help the analysis, but we should not label it binding without checking its authority in the relevant jurisdiction. I'll explain that distinction and identify what further research is needed.

Scenario 2 | Two sources with different purposes

A fictional research file contains a commentary article and a court decision discussing the same issue. Neither source's applicability to the matter has been assessed.

Role A: You supervise research. Explain why commentary and a decision serve different research roles.

Role B: You are the research assistant. Paraphrase the distinction and ask what authority and relevance checks remain.

Possible opening: The article may help explain the issue, but it is not interchangeable with the court's decision.

Success checks

- Distinguish explanation from judicial authority.
- Keep applicability unresolved for both sources.
- Agree to examine the decision and its authority before characterizing it.

Add a complication: The article is easier to read, and a colleague proposes citing it as controlling authority.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Proposing fifteen days without announcing agreement

The lesson's services draft says ten days; the commercial team needs fifteen. Wording remains subject to legal and counterparty review.

01 • Commercial manager: The draft requires delivery within ten days, but our team needs fifteen.

02 • Contract lawyer: We can propose a redline, provided it is clear that the change requires review and agreement.

03 • Commercial manager: Could you tell the customer that fifteen days is now the contractual commitment?

04 • Contract lawyer: Not before agreement. Our proposal doesn't amend the draft merely because we prefer it.

05 • Commercial manager: Should we also check whether delivery wording affects any related warranty provision?

06 • Contract lawyer: Yes. Connected terms need review rather than an isolated number change.

07 • Commercial manager: I can explain the operational requirement, but I can't approve the legal wording.

08 • Contract lawyer: Then bring that requirement into the negotiation and leave the drafting decision with the review team.

09 • Commercial manager: I'll present fifteen days as our requested timing, not as an accepted term.

10 • Contract lawyer: For review, I propose replacing 'within ten days' with 'within fifteen days', leaving the existing timing trigger and other wording unchanged. This remains subject to legal review and counterparty agreement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Scope reduction instead of an unsupported warranty

Separate fictional contract negotiation: a customer requests support for all equipment, while the supplier's proposal covers one named product line.

01 • Customer procurement lead: Could the warranty cover all our equipment, not only the named product line?

02 • Supplier contract manager: That's broader than the proposal. We can assess it, but cannot confirm coverage today.

03 • Customer procurement lead: Would keeping the current price be possible if we narrowed the request?

04 • Supplier contract manager: We can take a defined scope for review; pricing and warranty wording remain unapproved.

05 • Customer procurement lead: Then let's compare the named product line with a separately assessed expansion.

06 • Supplier contract manager: Agreed. We should also check related representations rather than promise capabilities we haven't verified.

07 • Customer procurement lead: I can identify the equipment list, but I won't describe expanded coverage as agreed.

08 • Supplier contract manager: Please do. That will make the review concrete without changing the current proposal silently.

09 • Customer procurement lead: We'll return to price after the scope and proposed terms have been assessed.

10 • Supplier contract manager: Good. For now, both the expansion and its conditions remain open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A liability request needs coordinated review

Separate fictional contract exercise: procurement requests a broader indemnity while the draft's limitation-of-liability section is still under review.

01 • Procurement manager: Can we accept the broader indemnity today and discuss the liability limit later?

02 • Contract counsel: Those provisions may interact. We should review them together before confirming acceptance.

03 • Procurement manager: I'm trying to keep negotiations moving. What can I offer as a practical next step?

04 • Contract counsel: Offer a coordinated review of the requested indemnity and the limitation-of-liability wording.

05 • Procurement manager: Could I say the business accepts the concept, subject to wording?

06 • Contract counsel: Only if that accurately reflects authorized instructions. We haven't established such acceptance here.

07 • Procurement manager: Then I'll say we are evaluating the request and ask for the counterparty's priority.

08 • Contract counsel: That preserves room for negotiation without inventing approval or explaining a legal effect prematurely.

09 • Procurement manager: I'll bring their response and the linked clauses to the review discussion.

10 • Contract counsel: Good. We can then formulate a conditional proposal grounded in the actual instructions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Contracts, Redlines, and Negotiation

A draft services agreement requires delivery within ten days. The commercial team needs fifteen days and wants the contract team to propose wording.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: Our delivery team can commit to fifteen days under the current scope. Could we revise the proposed period accordingly? I'll send the business rationale for legal review with the redline.

Scenario 2 | A milestone definition is missing

A fictional draft ties payment to completion of training, but the parties have not agreed whether completion means delivering the session or participants passing an assessment. No payment change is approved.

Role A: You represent the supplier's commercial team. Clarify the two meanings and propose a reviewable definition.

Role B: You coordinate contract review for the customer. State which interpretation needs internal confirmation.

Possible opening: Before we negotiate the payment milestone, could we clarify what completion of training means here?

Success checks

- Name both interpretations.
- Keep the payment obligation and definition unagreed.
- Agree an internal review step before making a conditional proposal.

Add a complication: A participant asks you to promise payment on delivery while the definition is still unresolved.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An interview allegation is not a confirmed violation

The lesson's interview reports possible misconduct; a manager wants the summary to call it a confirmed violation.

01 • Investigation analyst: The interview contains a report of possible misconduct, not a confirmed violation.

02 • Compliance manager: Can we use stronger wording so leadership understands the seriousness of the issue?

03 • Investigation analyst: We can take the report seriously without claiming a finding the evidence doesn't establish.

04 • Compliance manager: Then how should we distinguish the allegation from our current assessment?

05 • Investigation analyst: Attribute the account and state that corroboration and the relevant review remain pending.

06 • Compliance manager: Would proposing remediation mean we have already concluded a violation occurred?

07 • Investigation analyst: We should explain any proposed action's purpose separately, rather than let it imply a finding.

08 • Compliance manager: I'll avoid presenting the summary as an enforcement action or final determination.

09 • Investigation analyst: Please preserve the unresolved questions and route the information through the appropriate restricted process.

10 • Compliance manager: Agreed. The summary will reflect the report's seriousness and its actual evidential status.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A due-diligence gap is not a clean result

Separate fictional transaction review: due diligence received no response to one questionnaire section; no independent check has resolved it.

01 • Transaction manager: The questionnaire has no issues listed in that section. Can we call the review clean?

02 • Due-diligence lawyer: The section is unanswered, not a confirmed negative response. That distinction needs to remain visible.

03 • Transaction manager: So silence doesn't establish that no relevant matter exists for disclosure?

04 • Due-diligence lawyer: Correct. We have an information gap and no independent check resolving it.

05 • Transaction manager: Could the executive summary say the company withheld something important?

06 • Due-diligence lawyer: We don't know why the response is missing. Don't turn an omission into an allegation of intent.

07 • Transaction manager: I'll describe the unanswered section and request clarification through the review team.

08 • Due-diligence lawyer: Also identify what decision depends on the missing information without predicting the answer.

09 • Transaction manager: Then we can discuss the gap's implications after the response is assessed.

10 • Due-diligence lawyer: Exactly. The due-diligence status is incomplete, neither clean nor a confirmed adverse finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A remediation step without a causal conclusion

Separate fictional compliance exercise: a team added a second review to an expense process after an allegation; the investigation is unfinished.

01 • Operations manager: We added a second review, so can the summary say the alleged problem has been proven and fixed?

02 • Compliance reviewer: No. The process change is confirmed, but the investigation remains unfinished.

03 • Operations manager: I thought remediation meant we had already established exactly what went wrong.

04 • Compliance reviewer: Here, describe the precautionary process change and its purpose without implying a final finding.

05 • Operations manager: We also haven't tested whether the extra review addresses the concern effectively.

06 • Compliance reviewer: Then effectiveness is another open question, separate from whether the step was introduced.

07 • Operations manager: I'll state that the review was added while the allegation is still being assessed.

08 • Compliance reviewer: Good. Avoid claiming either confirmed misconduct or completed remediation on this evidence.

09 • Operations manager: We'll bring the investigation status and the process-check results to the next review.

10 • Compliance reviewer: That will distinguish the action taken from conclusions that still require support.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Corporate, Compliance, Regulatory, and Investigation Language

An employee interview contains a report of possible misconduct. A manager asks to describe the allegation as a confirmed violation in a summary.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: At this stage, we have an allegation and an interview record. The finding is not established. I'll use neutral wording and identify the questions that the investigation still needs to resolve.

Scenario 2 | An inquiry mistaken for enforcement

A fictional organization receives a request for information from a regulator. The supplied record contains no finding, sanction, or enforcement decision. A manager calls it a penalty notice.

Role A: You prepare compliance updates. Describe the received request and correct the unsupported label.

Role B: You are the manager. Ask which facts can be stated and who should assess the response.

Possible opening: The document requests information; the record does not show a penalty or enforcement finding.

Success checks

- Describe the document without either exaggerating or dismissing it.
- Keep its legal significance subject to qualified review.
- Agree the response-review owner rather than inventing a deadline or obligation.

Add a complication: Another colleague wants to call the request routine and harmless, which is also unassessed.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Timing and confidentiality before client instructions

The lesson's team disagrees on settlement priorities: one values timing, the other confidentiality. Counsel is preparing for a client discussion.

01 • Lead counsel: Let's hear both priorities before preparing the client discussion. What does each concern address?

02 • Associate counsel: One team member prioritizes timing, while the other wants confidentiality considered explicitly.

03 • Lead counsel: Have we established the client's own priorities, or only the team's preferences?

04 • Associate counsel: Only the team's preferences. We shouldn't describe either as the client's instruction to settle.

05 • Lead counsel: Agreed. Prepare questions that let the client explain the tradeoff rather than assume agreement.

06 • Associate counsel: Should we also distinguish discussing possible terms from authority to accept a settlement?

07 • Lead counsel: Yes. Decision authority must be clarified before anyone communicates acceptance on the client's behalf.

08 • Associate counsel: I'll present both priorities neutrally and identify what remains unresolved.

09 • Lead counsel: Invite any other relevant concern, then summarize the instructions accurately after the discussion.

10 • Associate counsel: Understood. Today's preparation produces questions, not a settlement decision or a promise of terms.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Agreeing a chronology without conceding liability

Separate fictional case conference: counsel considers asking the client about agreeing a limited chronology; no stipulation has been authorized.

01 • Case conference chair: We should clarify the proposed scope before asking whether the client would stipulate to anything.

02 • Associate lawyer: The discussion concerns a limited chronology, not an agreement about liability.

03 • Case conference chair: Has the client authorized even that limited proposal, or is this still preparation?

04 • Associate lawyer: It is still preparation. We need instructions and review of the exact points.

05 • Case conference chair: Then invite the factual reviewer's concerns before presenting the option to the client.

06 • Associate lawyer: I'll ask which dates are supported and which remain disputed in the record.

07 • Case conference chair: Good. Don't assume a possible stipulation resolves every issue connected to those dates.

08 • Associate lawyer: And any proposal to reserve rights needs qualified review, not a casual phrase added for reassurance.

09 • Case conference chair: Exactly. Close the meeting with the open factual points and the person seeking instructions.

10 • Associate lawyer: I'll seek the instructions after review and record that no agreement was reached today.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Protecting a dissenting settlement concern

Separate fictional mediation preparation: the commercial lead favors speed, but the operations representative has not discussed implementation feasibility.

01 • Mediation counsel: Before we recommend a settlement approach, we haven't heard operations on implementation feasibility.

02 • Operations representative: Thank you. I can't confirm feasibility until the proposed obligations are defined more clearly.

03 • Mediation counsel: Are you objecting to settlement itself, or to treating implementation as already confirmed?

04 • Operations representative: The latter. I don't want our silence represented as an operational commitment.

05 • Mediation counsel: I'll make that distinction. The commercial preference for speed doesn't answer your scope question.

06 • Operations representative: Who will decide which conditions can be offered once we understand the work?

07 • Mediation counsel: We need the appropriate client instructions; this preparation meeting doesn't supply that authority.

08 • Operations representative: Then I can help identify the operational questions without approving the proposed terms.

09 • Mediation counsel: Exactly. We'll take those questions to the decision discussion and keep them visible.

10 • Operations representative: Please close with implementation unresolved, not with an assumed agreement to proceed immediately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Advocacy, Settlement, Ethics, and Professional Judgment

Two team members disagree about settlement priorities. One prioritizes timing; the other prioritizes confidentiality. Counsel is preparing for a client discussion.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You hold a relevant concern that has not been discussed. Raise it when invited and ask who will decide. Help the facilitator state one unresolved question accurately.

Second round: A participant interrupts or the meeting is running out of time. Protect a turn to speak and close with an accurate decision record.

Model for scenario 1: Let's separate the objectives before discussing terms. How important are timing and confidentiality to the client? We can present the options and their implications for the client's instructions.

Scenario 2 | An enthusiastic response is not acceptance

In fictional settlement preparation, a business representative says an option sounds promising. They have not authorized acceptance, and counsel has not reviewed the proposed wording. Another participant wants to announce a deal.

Role A: You facilitate the discussion. Clarify the difference between interest and instructions to accept.

Role B: You are the business representative. Explain that you want further review and identify the decision still needed.

Possible opening: Promising describes your reaction, but could we clarify whether any acceptance has actually been authorized?

Success checks

- Preserve the absence of acceptance authority.
- Invite the representative's actual instruction.
- Close with review and decision responsibilities clear, not a claimed deal.

Add a complication: A participant says a quick announcement would create useful momentum.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

US Courts: glossary of legal terms

<https://www.uscourts.gov/glossary>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Law English

Professional audience: lawyers, paralegals, compliance staff, contracts specialists, legal operations teams, and law-adjacent professionals

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Dialogue 01: Client Intake: Strong Emotions, Missing Facts

Original fictional setting: A potential client calls after receiving a demand letter from a former business partner.

Professional roles: Client / Legal team / Associate counsel

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Client: They are lying. Can you tell them we will sue immediately?

Legal team: I understand this feels urgent. Before we discuss strategy, I need to gather facts and run a conflict check.

Associate counsel: Can you send the demand letter, the contract, and any recent emails with the former partner? Also, please list the company names and individuals involved so we can check conflicts.

Client: So do we have a case?

Associate counsel: I cannot assess that responsibly from one call. After we review the documents and confirm scope, we can identify claims, defenses, deadlines, and practical options.

Client: I can send the letter and contract through your secure intake channel. What else do you need before deciding whether to act?

Associate counsel: The party names for the conflict check and the relevant dates. We will explain any engagement terms before undertaking representation.

Vocabulary in this exchange: Representation: A statement of fact made by a party, often used to allocate risk.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

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Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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Client: I can send the letter and contract through your secure intake channel. What else do you need before deciding whether to act?

Associate counsel: The party names for the conflict check and the relevant dates. We will explain any engagement terms before undertaking representation.

Vocabulary in this exchange: Representation: A statement of fact made by a party, often used to allocate risk.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level